

Language Study

Grammar
Dictation
Penmanship & Copywork
Written Narration





About the Course

This course includes the following topic(s): Grammar: Grade 4, Dictation: Grade 4, Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 4, Written Narration: Grade 4

About Grammar: Grade 4

Students learn the parts of speech through a four-part analysis.

About Dictation: Grade 4

Students use selected passages to practice dictation skills. (Alveary Copywork & Dictation Books provide selected passages).

About Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 4

Students copy short passages from their books. (Alveary Copywork & Dictation Books provide selected passages).

About Written Narration: Grade 4

Students begin to make written narrations a weekly habit.



Placement & Combining Tips

Language Study: Grade 4

Grade 4 students who did not complete all three levels of the Alveary Reading Lessons, who are having difficulty with spelling, who cannot read well enough to narrate, or who make more than 10 errors in a 100-word passage should continue the reading lessons while the teacher dials back on the amount of reading required in other subjects.

Written Narration: Grade 4

Students who are not yet secure with their penmanship are not yet ready for written narration. Instead of written narrations, use the time to have students work on skills that will better support their development. Also, be sure to include typing in life skills!



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
4	Grammar: Grade 4 2 times/week 15 min	Grammar Island Grammar Island Teacher Manual (select pages) Practice Island Practice Island Teacher Manual (select pages)
4	Dictation: Grade 4 3 times/week 15 min	Grade 4 Copywork & Dictation Book
4	Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 4 5 times/week 10 min	Getty-Dubay® Italic Handwriting Book E Italics: Beautiful Handwriting for Children Grade 4 Copywork & Dictation Book
4	Written Narration: Grade 4 1 time/week 10 min	

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Language Study: Grade 4				



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 4

If you are using the Getty-Dubay Italic Handwriting Series, complete half a page per day or go at student's pace.

Written Narration: Grade 4

☐ Plan to complete one written narration every week and consider increasing to two by the end of the year.

☐ Written narrations can happen after reading at the end of any lesson if time allows and do not need to take up an extra 10 minutes in your schedule. This tracker serves to help you keep records of what was done throughout the year.

☐ To keep written narrations fresh and interesting, you can try different ways to have your students narrate what they read or observed outside. In addition to just "what did we read about?", you can ask students to "write the story of ____." (Example: "Write the story of Loki.") Some students may also like to imagine they are a character in the story and write what happened as a diary entry (Example: "Pretend you are Christian in Pilgrim's Progress and write a letter or diary entry telling what happened to him in today's chapter.")

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

Grammar: Grade 4

☐ Bookmark or Print Grammar Island Additional Practice PDF (Find in Quick Links)

☐ Bookmark Grammar Island Teacher Manual select pages for lesson answer key (Find in Quick Links)

☐ Bookmark Practice Island Teacher Manual for answer key (Find in Quick Links)

Written Narration: Grade 4

Some ideas on helping students transition to written narration:

☐ Write down words on a whiteboard if a student wants to use a word they don't know how to spell.

☐ Have students write down brief sentences (even numbered statements) telling the sequence of events, and then have them orally give more details about each of them.

☐ Write the beginning and then orally tell the rest, or vice versa.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Language Study: Grade 4

Grammar: Grade 4



Grammar Island



Grammar Island Teacher Manual (select pages)



Practice Island



Practice Island Teacher Manual (select pages)

Dictation: Grade 4



Grade 4 Copywork & Dictation Book

Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 4



Getty-Dubay® Italic Handwriting Book E



Italics: Beautiful Handwriting for Children



Grade 4 Copywork & Dictation Book



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)
(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Language Study: Grade 4

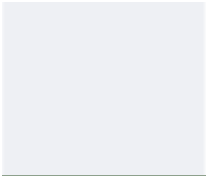
- ∞ [Extra Helpings](#)
- ∞ [Copywork & Dictation: Grade 4](#)
- ∞ [Foundations \(See Sections 3 & 8: Narration & English\)](#)

Grammar: Grade 4

- ∞ [Grammar Island Additional Practice PDF](#)
- ∞ [Grammar Island Additional Practice PDF Answer Key](#)
- ∞ [2 group games for Grammar Island](#)
- ∞ [Grammar Island Teacher Manual select pages for lesson answer key](#)
- ∞ [Practice Island Teacher Manual for answer key](#)
- ∞ [Grammar Island Pg. Numbers/Beginning Ending Quotes Ebook](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.





Dictation: Grade 4

- ∞ [Alveary Phonogram Teachers Guide & Key](#)
 - ∞ [English Reading & Spelling Patterns](#)
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SAMPLE

Language Study: Grade 4

How To Teach Grammar



Connect

Link back to the previous lesson.



Read

Read the assigned pages and discuss new ideas. It is important for students to be able to talk about the concepts in their own words. The pictures and diagrams in the book can serve as a springboard for discussions about the grammar concepts.



Practice

Complete practice examples in the text and/or the practice book that accompany the lesson.



Observe

Observe examples of concepts in books being read and in daily life.

Language Study: Grade 4

How To Teach Dictation



Prepare

Select a passage that has already been read and narrated. (We provide passages in the Dictation packets.) Have students read over it and select 4-5 words that they don't know. They can also mark punctuation that may be difficult to remember. They only need to select a section that contains 4-5 new words. If this is only a couple of sentences, that is fine.



Discuss

Ask students which words they think will be most difficult to spell and why. If there is a common spelling pattern, you can point that out. Use the Alveray Phonogram Teacher's Guide or the English Reading & Spelling Patterns sheets to find common spelling patterns. You can also point out other words that have a similar pattern.



Practice

Have students visualize the words by "seeing" them with their eyes closed. They should also practice on a whiteboard.



Complete

As part of the same lesson, when students feel ready, slowly call out a sentence from what they studied. You will want to read it phrase by phrase and not repeat it.



View

When finished, have students look over their own work to check and see that everything looks right. If you see any misspelled words, erase those and have the students practice those again.

Language Study: Grade 4

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Term 1

WEEK 1 10m Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 4 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

☐ Materials: Grade 4 Student packet of copywork and dictation passages

→ COPYWORK

Spend ten minutes daily working on copywork this week. You can use this week's suggested passage or choose your own of a similar length. Spend the first 3-5 minutes of your copywork lesson focusing on penmanship by practicing a few letters in print or cursive from the Penny Gardner book or another style of your choice.

WEEK 1 15m Dictation: Grade 4 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐

☐ Materials: Grade 4 Student packet of copywork and dictation passages

→ DICTATION

Three dictation lessons are scheduled each week over one passage. In each lesson, there should be time for studying (10 min) and time for the sentences to be dictated (5 min). You can use this week's suggested passage for the lessons and/or choose your own generally from the history, literature, or geography books the student has already read during the week. The suggested passage might take one lesson to learn, or it might take all three lessons to learn. It will be different for each student. Be sure to pay attention to any notes regarding grammar or punctuation added to the student dictation packet for the week.

Enough text to include 4-5 unknown words should be studied by the student. This might mean that the student is only studying a couple of sentences. Ask for the words they do not know how to spell. Write them down on a chalkboard, whiteboard, or piece of paper. The student should work on visualizing each word until they can see it with their eyes shut, and then practice writing the word, drawing the letters in the air, or saying the letters aloud until it is memorized.

Discuss any interesting spelling patterns or punctuation from the text being studied. Use the Alveary Phonogram Teacher's Guide or the English Reading & Spelling Patterns sheets to find common spelling patterns. The process should take around 10 minutes to this point.

∞ Link: Alveary Phonogram Teacher's Guide

∞ Link: English Reading & Spelling Patterns

Then, choose a sentence or two to slowly dictate a few words at a time to the student from the text studied. Read it once. Correct any errors and revisit any words missed.

Be sure to adapt the amount studied and dictated to suit the student. Add to or subtract from the amount or difficulty of the text studied to ensure the student's success and growth.

WEEK 1 10m Written Narration: Grade 4 - Lesson 1

→ WRITTEN NARRATION

Complete one written narration this week. Make sure to write on a variety of different subjects, either over the term or at least over the year.

→ NOTE

Written narrations can happen at the end of any lesson if time allows and do not need to take up an extra 10 minutes in your schedule. This tracker serves to help you keep records of what was done throughout the year.

★ TEACHER TIP

Note that students who are not yet secure with their penmanship are not yet ready for written narration. Instead of written narrations, use the time to have students work on skills that will better support their development, such as climbing on trees or playground equipment,

Language Study: Grade 4

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Term 1

WEEK 1 15m Grammar: Grade 4 - Lesson 1

Introduction

Materials: Grammar Island

→ INTRO

Did you know that sentences do not occur in nature? Language comes from us; it is ourselves, in words!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Grammar Island p.5-8

→ DISCUSS

How is a word different from a random group of letters, like "dixerp?"

doing household chores, working with clay or dough, and doing mazes and dot-to-dot activities. Also, be sure to include typing in life skills!

★ TEACHER TIP

The key to explaining the four levels of grammar revolves around the noun and the verb.

Parts of Speech: Noun and Verb

Parts of Sentence: Subject and Predicate

Phrases: No Subject Predicate allowed

Clauses: Subject Predicate required

WEEK 1 15m Grammar: Grade 4 - Lesson 2

What Is Grammar?

Materials: Grammar Island

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Grammar Island p.9-11

→ DISCUSS

Think about a team sport. How are the players different from the game? How could this idea be applied to language?

WEEK 2 10m Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 4 - Tracker

Tracker: □□□□□

Materials: Grade 4 Student packet of copywork and dictation passages

→ COPYWORK

Spend ten minutes daily working on copywork this week. You can use this week's suggested passage or choose your own of a similar length. Spend the first 3-5 minutes of your copywork lesson focusing on penmanship by practicing a few letters in print or cursive from the Penny Gardner book or another style of your choice.

WEEK 2 15m Dictation: Grade 4 - Tracker

Tracker: □□□

Materials: Grade 4 Student packet of copywork and dictation passages

→ DICTATION

Spend three days this week working on a complete dictation lesson (10 min. of study and 5 min. for passage to be dictated). You can use this week's suggested passage or choose your own of a similar length. Be sure to pay attention to any added notes in the student dictation packet for the week. Only choose enough text so the student learns 4-5 new words at a time.

Language Study: Grade 4

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Term 1

WEEK 2 10m Written Narration: Grade 4 - Lesson 2

→ WRITTEN NARRATION

Complete one written narration this week.

→ NOTE

If the student is new to written narration, they may fatigue quickly. Allow them to initially write a bit, and tell the rest. Some may do better by first orally narrating and discussing as usual, then writing a sentence or so of that narration. Others may do better by beginning their narration in writing, then completing it orally.

★ TEACHER TIP

One way to help students transition to written narrations is to provide external supports before writing, such as index cards that can be arranged and re-ordered. You can also encourage students to talk aloud as they write or use speech-to-text and then edit.

WEEK 2 15m Grammar: Grade 4 - Lesson 3

The Parts of Speech

Materials: Grammar Island

→ INTRO

What do we mean when we say the "parts of a bird"? [the small bits that make up the whole bird] Our language has parts that make up the whole, too.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Grammar Island p.13-19

→ DIAGRAM

Copy the diagram on p.17. Color the parts with crayons or colored pencils to match the drawing. Which parts seem most important?

WEEK 2 15m Grammar: Grade 4 - Lesson 4

Nouns

Materials: Grammar Island

→ RECAP

What are the two main kinds of words? [nouns and verbs]

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Grammar Island p.20-21

→ PLAY

What would it be like if you could only talk in nouns? Try it! Can it work? [Remember, you can only use words that NAME things!]

WEEK 3 10m Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 4 - Tracker

Tracker: □ □ □ □ □

Materials: Grade 4 Student packet of copywork and dictation passages

→ COPYWORK

Spend ten minutes daily working on copywork this week. You can use this week's suggested passage or choose your own of a similar length. Spend the first 3-5 minutes of your copywork lesson focusing on penmanship by practicing a few letters in print or cursive from the Penny Gardner book or another style of your choice.

Language Study: Grade 4

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Term 1

WEEK 3 15m Dictation: Grade 4 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐

Materials: Grade 4 Student packet of copywork and dictation passages

→ DICTATION

Spend three days this week working on dictation.

WEEK 3 10m Written Narration: Grade 4 - Lesson 3

→ WRITTEN NARRATION

Complete one written narration this week.

★ TEACHER TIP

Make sure students are practicing typing skills regularly, and have them try typing a narration occasionally.

WEEK 3 15m Grammar: Grade 4 - Lesson 5

Pronouns

Materials: Grammar Island

→ INTRO

How do we know when to use the word "I" and when to use "me"? Think of a sentence with each.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Grammar Island p.22-24

→ DISCUSS

The prefix "pro" means "for." A "Pro-noun" is a word you use "for a noun." "Ante" means "before," and "cede" means "to go." So, the noun that "went before" the pronoun is called its "antecedent." Read the left column on p.24 aloud and time it; read the right column aloud and time it. Pronouns are quick!

WEEK 3 15m Grammar: Grade 4 - Lesson 6

Subject Pronouns

Materials: Grammar Island

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Grammar Island p.25-27

→ WRITE

Copy the lists of subject pronouns and object pronouns. Look at the last narration you wrote. Did you use any pronouns? Circle them with an aqua pencil.